How to Create a 2-Column Layout in Adobe InDesign

Introduction

This tutorial explains how to create a two-column text layout and vertically justify the text in Adobe InDesign. These steps are designed for beginners who are new to working with text frames and layout settings.

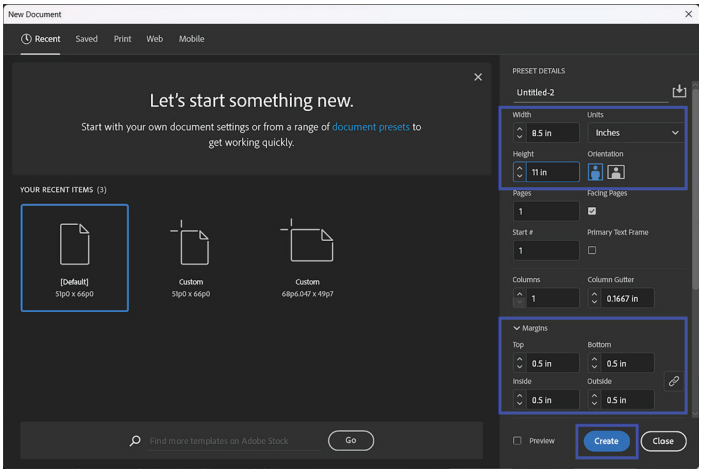
Materials

- Adobe InDesign
- Text content to place into the document

Instructions

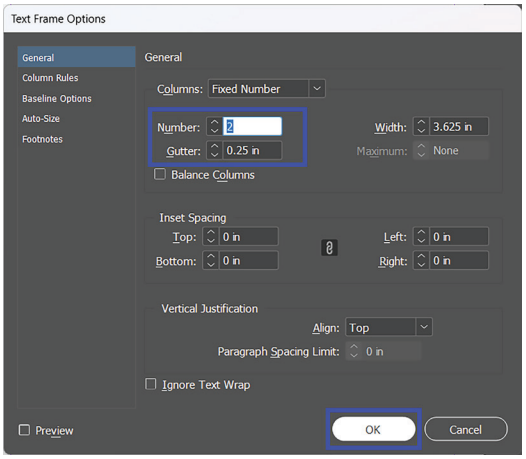
1. In Adobe InDesign, select File > New > Document to create a new document.
2. Set the page size, margins, and other document settings.
3. Click Create to open the document.

Figure 1. New document setup window. (Source: Author)



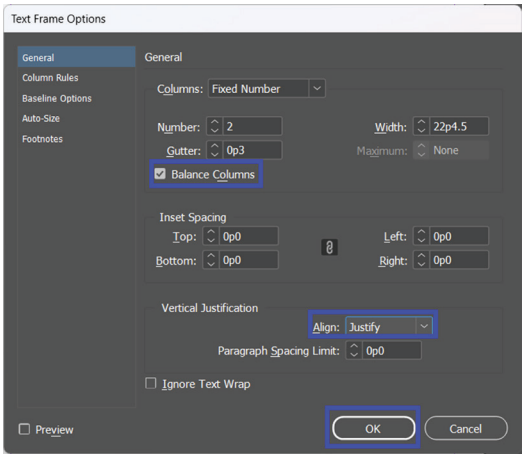
4. Select the Type Tool from the toolbar.
5. Click and drag to create a text frame in the desired size. The purple lines on the page represent the margin guides.
6. Go to Object > Text Frame Options to open the Text Frame Options panel.
7. Set the number of columns to 2.
8. Adjust the gutter value to control spacing between columns.
9. Click OK to apply the column settings.

Figure 2. Text Frame Options panel showing column settings. (Source: Author)



10. Type or paste your text into the frame.
11. To balance the length of the columns, go to Object > Text Frame Options to open the Text Frame Options panel again.
12. Locate the Vertical Justification section.
13. Change the vertical alignment to Justify.
14. Click OK to apply the settings.

Figure 3. Vertical justification settings in Text Frame Options. (Source: Author)



15. Save your completed document.

Conclusion

You have now created a two-column layout and applied vertical justification to your text. These tools can help improve the organization and appearance of longer documents.